

SWIMMING SLUG

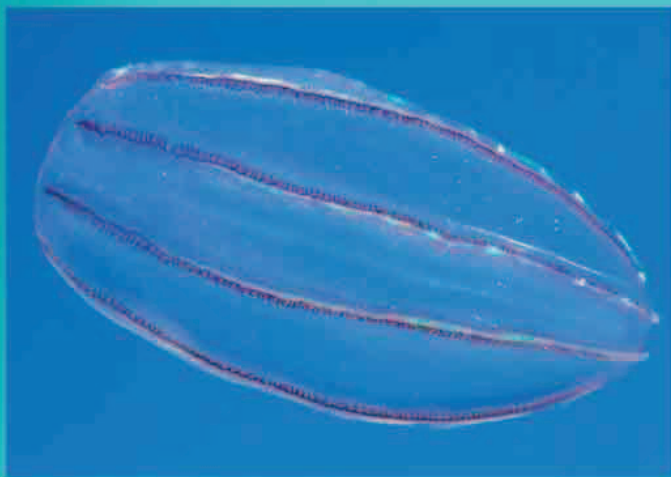
Despite its deadly sting, the Portuguese man-of-war is preyed upon by another animal that also lives among the plankton—the blue sea slug. Unlike most sea slugs, it swims in open water, attacking and eating other animals. Amazingly, the blue sea slug recycles the stinging cells of its venomous prey and uses them for its own defense.

Each tentacle carries hundreds of stinging cells



GLITTERING JELLIES

Although they look like jellyfish, the comb jellies are very different. Their name refers to the shimmering rows of mobile “combs” along their bodies. By flicking these back and forth, the animals push themselves through the water. Some have long tentacles for snaring prey.



DRIFTING CHAINS

Even stranger than the comb jellies are the drifting chains of salps that filter the water for phytoplankton. These tubular, transparent creatures are open-water relatives of the sea squirts that live attached to rocks. For part of their lifecycle, salps live alone, but breed by producing long chains of identical, cloned animals that drift in the sunlit zone of the ocean. Eventually, each member of the chain produces another generation of solitary salps.

